On the other hand, if you're working on a team responsible for providing data, your team is a good candidate to be a provider. Start speaking to one of your consumers and letting them know you're on board with verifying the contract tests.

It's also recommended to find allies or champions from both the consumer and provider teams so they can champion the idea of contract testing and communicate the work that will need to happen.

2.6.3 Define the contract

The contract process is slightly different in contract testing, especially in consumer-driven contract testing. The consumer defines the contract, which details the expectations they require from the provider. This also enforces an agreement going forward that the provider must meet the expectations defined by the consumer.

At this stage, it's perfectly fine to define the initial contract manually. For now, you can store this in a location that your team can access or a Microsoft Word document—whichever works for you. At this stage, just write the minimal contract that is needed by the consumer and provider. We'll automate the generation of the contract at a later stage when you write the consumer contract test, but it's still handy to have an initial understanding of how the consumer and provider will interact. An example contract is shown here:

ExampleApp and User API contract

> Consumer: ExampleApp
>
> Provider: User API
>
> Given there is an "ExampleApp" that uses "User API"
>
> When it sends a request to "/user/marie"
>
> Then the "User API" should respond with a status code of 200
>
> And the "User API" should return the following:
>
> - ID (integer)
> - Full name (string)